

Letter Samples

Chapter: 6

Disclaimer: These examples are for reading and understanding of the types of letters only.
Do not take them as samples for format; follow the required format while writing (e.g. Block Format.

1. Letter of Acknowledgement

- Sent to acknowledge receipt of something when a written record is appropriate.
- An acknowledge may also be sent to acknowledge receipt of another letter or document which requires further attention. As such you would clearly state that you will look into the matter and reply in more detail at a later date.

Dear Ms Hyams

Thank you for your letter of 17 January in which you enquire about our company finance services.

I have pleasure in enclosing a leaflet which gives full details of the services we offer, and also supplies some information about the company's history and present size and condition.

Should you require any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Yours sincerely

H L Warner

Customer Services Manager

2. LETTER OF ENQUIRY

- Enquiries for information about goods or services are sent and received in business all the time.
- In your letter remember to state clearly exactly what you want – information? a catalogue? a price list? a quotation?
- Keep your enquiry brief and to the point.

Dear Sir

Our company is currently renewing its computer equipment in the accounts department.

I am writing to enquire about the possibility of a representative of your company visiting us to advise about the number and kind of desk-top computers we need to provide an up-to-date system for our rapidly expanding business.

Perhaps you would like to telephone my secretary to arrange an appointment to call and discuss the matter with me.

Yours faithfully

P L Mackintosh
Accounts Manager

3. Letter of Complaint

- When you have a genuine complaint, you will feel angry but remember that the other party may not to be blame .
- They may have a perfectly good defense. Therefore, your letter should be confined to a statement of the facts followed by an enquiry about what the company will do about it or a suggestion of how you expect the matter to be dealt with.
- At all costs **avoid rudeness** .

27 June 20..

Dear Mr. Green,

Re: telephone conversation Wednesday 2 June 20..-non-delivery of wardrobe

It would seem that you have been unable to trace my wardrobe in your warehouse as a further three days have elapsed since our last telephone conversation and my wardrobe has not arrived.

I have now waited for six weeks and frankly, were it not for the fact that it forms parts of a fully fitted (matching) bedroom, would have preferred to cancel my order.

At this stage I would like a guaranteed date of delivery and recompense for the inconvenience you have caused me. I have had to take three days' holiday to date to await delivery of the aforesaid wardrobe.

I would appreciate your earliest attention to this matter.

Yours sincerely,

Mrs. J. Brown

USEFUL PHRASES FOR LETTER OF COMPLAINT

- I am displeased with the quality of these goods.
- This is causing us a great deal of inconvenience.
- Please look into this and arrange for the goods to be replaced.
- These goods are well below the standard expected.
- I expect to receive a complete refund soon.
- The standard of workmanship is totally inadequate.
- You assured me that you would deliver these goods within one week.

4. Adjustment Letter

- Adjustment letter gives an opportunity to investigate, explain and put things right.

~~February 3, 2001~~

Ms. Alma D. Alcantara ♦ EDP Enterprise ♦ Pasay, Paranaque

Dear Mrs. Alcantara:

We are sorry to hear about the poor performance of your new air-conditioning unit.

We suggest that you explain the dissatisfaction you are having to our air-conditioner technical person whom we are sending to your place.

We are always glad to be of service to you.

Sincerely,
Jenlyn M. Tapang

USEFUL PHRASES FOR LETTER OF ADJUSTMENT

- I have looked into this matter and have found out that...
- I am very sorry to hear about...
- Please accept my apologies for any inconvenience caused.
- Thank you for bringing the matter to our attention.
- I sincerely hope that you will have no further problems with this replacement order.

Don'ts of Letter Writing

- Make grammar or usage errors
- Use clichés or worn-out phrases
- Use obsolete and/or pompous language because it "seems" more professional
- Be too familiar with your audience
- Use humor unless you know what you are doing
- Preach
- Brag

Do's of Letter Writing

- Use plain English
- Write in active voice when possible
- Use short sentences when possible
- Use everyday words and avoid technical jargon
- Use lists to present complex materials
- Select the words you use very carefully
- Use a strong organizational strategy
- Use a reader centered tone
- Use a business like, conversational tone

Correspondence Guidelines

- 1. Know Your Purpose
- 2. Know Your Readers
- 3. Follow Correct Format (CONTENT + FORMAT)
- 4. Follow ABC Format
- 5. Follow the 3 Cs Strategy (Capture, Convince, Contact)
- 6. Stress the You Attitude
- 7. Use Attachment for Details
- 8. Be Diplomatic
- 9. Edit Carefully
- 10. Respond Quickly